



I'M DONE

But My

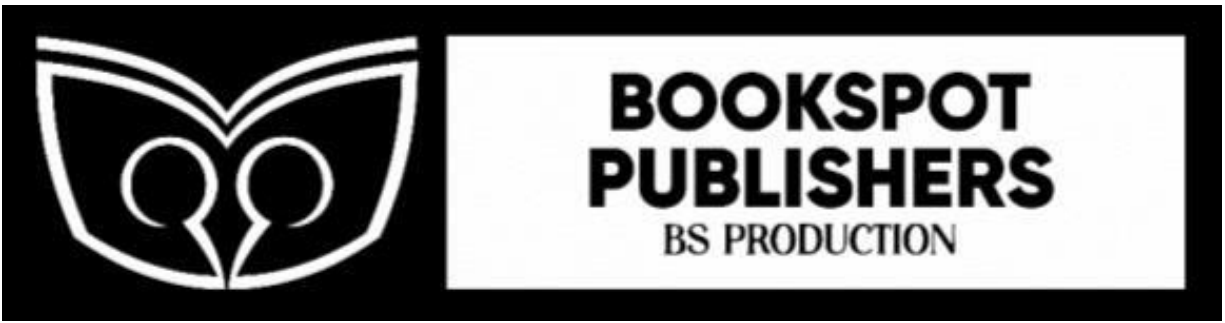
Heart

Still Whispers
Your Name

ANKIT BHATT

A journey through love,
loss and healing





I'M DONE,

But My

Heart

Still Whispers

Your Name

Ankit Bhatt

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“Not All Endings Are Silent Some Still Hum Softly In The Heart.”

This book is for you.

For the quiet lovers,

the silent healers,

the ones who still look at love

and say, “Maybe again.”

I'M DONE, BUT
MY HEART
STILL WHISPERS
YOUR NAME



Author's Note -

I didn't write this book to move on —

I wrote it to understand why I couldn't.

Every page is a reflection of what it feels like to love someone deeply,

to lose them quietly,

and to still carry them softly inside you.

This isn't just my story.

It's for anyone who ever stayed up replaying memories, for anyone whose silence was louder than their words.

It's for the hearts that break beautifully —

not because they are weak,

but because they still believe.

If you are reading this,

I hope you find pieces of yourself in these pages.

I hope you learn that it's okay to still whisper their name —

as long as you whisper your own louder.

— Ankit Bhatt

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Chapter 1

The Beginning Felt Like Home

“Some people don’t enter your life — they return.

You just don’t remember the last time they left.”

I met you on an ordinary day —

and nothing about that day felt extraordinary.

But somehow, you did.

You walked in quietly,

like a pause between two loud moments of my life, and everything that used to matter —

just didn’t.

I don’t know what drew me first — your eyes, your laugh, or the strange calm you carried

as if you had already seen my chaos

and decided to stay anyway.

You didn’t try too hard.

1

You didn’t have to.

You were the kind of peace

I didn't know how to ask for.

That day, the world felt a little slower, and for the first time in years,

I wasn't running from anything.

I was walking toward something —

toward you.

Maybe it was destiny,

or maybe just timing,

but the universe has a way

of letting broken people collide

at the exact second

they forget what love feels like.

You smiled — and I believed again.

That evening, you told me you liked sunsets.

I said I liked people who stayed to watch them.

You laughed.

2

And in that laugh,

I found the first home I'd ever trust again.

You weren't perfect.

Neither was I.

But somehow, together, we made the world feel right —
even if it wasn't.

3

“Home”

You didn't save me,

you reminded me

that softness still exists.

I never knew love could whisper,

until you spoke my name

like a prayer you already believed in.

You felt like home,

not the kind made of walls —

but the kind made of eyes

that finally see you.

And just like that,

without promises,

without plans,

you became the place

I didn't want to leave.

*Chapter 2**When Eyes Spoke First*

“Sometimes, souls speak before people do —
and eyes become the first language of love.”

It wasn’t a grand moment — no music, no script.

Just two glances that met halfway,
and neither of them knew where to go next.

You looked at me like you’d been here before —
in another time, another story,
maybe even another heartbreak.

There was nothing loud about you.

No big gestures, no words to fill the air.

You just looked —
and somehow that silence
said everything I’d been dying to hear.

I think that’s when love started to bloom —

not with touch, not with confession, but with the stillness between two
people who suddenly forgot the noise around them.

The world blurred a little.

The café, the crowd, the clock —

they all existed,

but for that small moment,

only your eyes felt real.

There's a strange comfort

in being understood without saying a word.

Like your soul finally meets someone who doesn't need subtitles to feel you.

That's what your gaze was —

a quiet understanding,

a soft "I see you"

that no one had ever said before.

I smiled —

6

not because it was funny, but because for the first time,

I didn't feel invisible.

And when you smiled back,

I think the universe exhaled.

7

"The First Language"

We didn't talk that day,

but your eyes
wrote me a letter
my heart never forgot to read.
Some glances
don't end in seconds —
they echo in your bones
for years.
I never believed in soulmates,
until your silence
began to understand mine.
That night, I came home
and replayed the look a thousand times.
Not because it was perfect —
but because it was real.
And maybe that's how it always starts —
not with fireworks,
but with a heartbeat that finally finds rhythm in someone else's eyes.

8

Chapter 3

Coffee, Chaos &

Conversations

“Some bonds don’t begin with love —

they begin with comfort,

and grow into something even love can’t define.”

You texted me first that morning.

A casual “coffee?” —

as if it didn’t mean everything.

I said yes too quickly,

trying not to sound like I’d been waiting for that message since the moment
I met you.

We met at a tiny café

that smelled like rain and roasted beans.

You were already there —

sitting near the window,

9

watching droplets race each other down the glass.

You looked at me and smiled —

and somehow,

every bad day I’d ever had

suddenly made sense.

We talked.

Not about deep things,
not about forever —
just random chaos:
movies, fears, little pieces of ourselves that felt safe to give away.
You laughed at my sarcasm.
I noticed how your eyes lit up
when you spoke about your dreams.
It wasn't love yet —
but it was something.
Something that made the air feel softer.
Something that made me want to stay a little longer.

10

There was a moment —
when you leaned in to say something, and your hand brushed against mine.
It wasn't intentional,
but it lingered.
Like the universe testing
how close two people could get
before their hearts forget to act normal.
The coffee turned cold,

but we didn't care.

We were busy discovering
how good silence could taste
when shared with the right person.

11

“Caffeine & Calm”

The cup went cold,
but the warmth stayed.

You spoke,
and my world slowed down
just enough to listen.

It wasn't love yet —
but it felt like the start
of something I'd spend forever writing about.

That evening,
you sent me a text:

“Let's do this again sometime.”

And I smiled —
because I already knew,
I'd say yes

every single time.

12

Chapter 4

Your Name Felt Like A

Poem

“Some names aren’t just spoken — they are felt, like verses that stay in the chest long after the music stops.”

I don’t remember when I stopped calling your name out loud.

Maybe the day I realized even the echo didn’t come back.

Your name... it still feels like a poem I forgot how to read —

soft, unfinished, hanging between the lines of my silence.

I still write it sometimes.

On fogged windows.

On torn paper corners.

Inside my mind, when loneliness whispers your memory.

You used to say,

“Love me like a story you’d never end.”

And I did — but you changed the ending without telling me.

Even now, when someone mentions your name, 13

my heart stumbles for a second — like a reader pausing on a familiar word.

Because your name wasn't just a name — it was a rhythm, a prayer that my lips learned before my mind ever did.

I still remember that evening under the flickering streetlight.

You were tracing our initials on the park bench, smiling, and I told you, “If one day we fade away, I'll still remember this light.”

You laughed, saying,

“Then promise me, you'll remember me too.”

I did.

I still do.

Even now, when life feels like blank paper, your name is that one word written in ink that refuses to fade.

It's not love anymore — it's the shadow of love, the kind that doesn't hurt as much as it hums quietly, in the background of every calm night.

Maybe you were never meant to stay.

Maybe I was just meant to feel.

And maybe... that's what love truly is —

remembering someone in a language they'll never hear again.

14

“Unwritten Name”

Your name—

it still breathes in my letters,

in pauses between words I never send.

Like rain remembering the cloud it fell from, my heart remembers the voice
it broke on.

You were a sentence I never finished, a melody that ended too soon—
yet somehow,
every poem I write
still begins with you.

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Chapter 5

The Night I Forgot How To

Pray

“Some nights don’t end with sleep... they end with silence swallowing
everything you once believed in.”

That night felt heavier than the sky itself.

The kind of night that makes you forget how to breathe, how to hope,
how to pray.

I remember sitting by the window,
watching raindrops race down the glass, and realizing —

I no longer had anyone to wish for.

There was a time when my prayers had your name.

I used to whisper it softly,
as if God needed reminding of who made my heart alive.

But that night...

I had nothing to say.

Maybe that's what heartbreak truly is —

not the moment they leave,

but the moment you stop asking the universe to bring them back.

I wanted to cry,

but even my tears had grown tired of repeating your story.

I wanted to hate you,

but how do you hate the one who taught you how to love silence?

Flashbacks kept visiting —

that temple we once went to,

where you tied your prayer thread and said,

“See? We’re destined.”

I wonder if you ever looked back at it after you walked away.

Because I did.

Every single time I passed by that place.

The thread was still there,

but the promise wasn't.

That night I didn't pray for you.

I didn't pray for love.

I just folded my hands

and whispered —

“Please, let me forget.”

But the cruel thing about love is —

you can forget the face,

but never the feeling.

You can stop praying for someone,

but you'll still find their name

in every silence that follows your Amen.

18

“I Prayed Once”

I prayed once—

not for love to return,

but for pain to slow its pace.

I prayed once—

not to see you again,

but to stop seeing you

in every reflection.

And maybe God heard me halfway—
you never came back,
but neither did peace.

19

Chapter 6

When Memories Smelled

Like Rain

“Sometimes it’s not the rain that hurts... it’s the way it reminds you of someone who once stayed to watch it with you.”

It rained after weeks that evening.

The kind of rain that doesn’t rush — it lingers, like a lover who knows it has nowhere else to go.

And just like that,
your memories returned — not loud, not sudden —
just the quiet drizzle of everything I tried to forget.

Do you remember how you used to say,

“Rain feels like our story — messy, soft, but somehow beautiful”?

Back then, I smiled,
never realizing that one day,

20

it would feel like an echo of everything I lost.

The smell of wet soil filled the air, and for a second, I could almost hear your laugh in the thunder that followed.

You always said storms were romantic —
you were wrong.

They're lonely when you're gone.

I walked to the same street
where we once shared an umbrella that barely covered us.

You were shivering,
and I held your hand like it was the only thing keeping the world steady.

Now, years later,
the rain touched that same skin — but it didn't warm me, it just reminded me that some touches never come back.

They say memories fade.

But how do you erase something that has a scent?

The rain smelled like you —

21

like jasmine and goodbye.

Maybe that's the hardest part about healing —
you move on,
but the world doesn't.

It keeps playing your memories in different seasons, until one day, you stop fighting it

and just let it rain inside you.

22

“The Rain You Left Behind”

The rain still carries your laughter, hidden in its hush.

Each drop —

a word we never said,

a touch we couldn't keep.

I tried to wash you away,

but love stains deeper than water.

Now every drizzle feels like confession, and every storm—

your name,

spelled in thunder.

23

Chapter 7

The Letters I Never Sent

“Not every letter needs to be posted—some are meant to bleed silently inside envelopes that never reach their names.”

I used to write to you after you left.

Not because I thought you'd read them, but because silence needed
somewhere to live.

Every page was a conversation I was too afraid to have—
inked in hope, sealed in heartbreak.

I'd begin the same way every time:

“Hi, it's still me.”

Some letters were long,
pages filled with the kind of honesty I never spoke when you were here.
Others were short—just one line,
like “I still think of you when it rains.”

24

Sometimes I'd imagine you opening one.

Sitting quietly,
tracing my words with your fingers the way you once did my skin.

But the truth was simpler—

you moved on,

and I was still writing to the past.

I remember one letter in particular.

It was about that evening by the river, when you said, “We'll never run out
of things to say.”

How ironic—

we drowned in silence, not words.

I never posted those letters.

They stayed in a small wooden box,

tied together with a ribbon that's lost its color now.

Maybe one day I'll burn them,

or maybe I'll keep them forever—

because even if you forgot me,

those letters remind me that once, I could love without fear.

25

It's strange—

how the things we never send

end up saying the most.

26

“Unposted”

There are letters that still breathe your name, in folded corners and trembling ink.

Words that never left my room,

but still reached your absence somehow.

I didn't need you to read them—

I just needed to remember

that love once spoke through me,

even if it was never heard.

27

Chapter 8

The Things We Left Unsaid

“Sometimes silence is the loudest chapter in a love story.”

There are still so many things I never told you.

Not because I didn’t want to,

but because I didn’t know how to speak when my heart was trembling.

I wanted to tell you that I noticed —

the way your eyes softened when you talked about dreams, the way you bit your lip when you were nervous, the way you said my name like it was a secret you were afraid to lose.

But I never said any of it.

Maybe love isn’t about saying everything —

maybe it’s about feeling too much to put into words.

There were times when I wanted to ask,

“Do you still think of me?”

28

But I never did,

because I was scared your silence would be the answer.

We always spoke like tomorrow was promised.

We never planned for the day

when “us” would become “was.”

Now, when I replay those last conversations, I realize how much of our story lived between pauses —

in glances, in hesitations, in sighs that almost became confessions.

You left,

but it wasn't your leaving that broke me —

it was all the words that stayed behind, trapped in my chest like birds that forgot how to fly.

If I could go back,

I wouldn't beg you to stay.

I'd just tell you one thing:

“I loved you in silence... and maybe that's why it still hurts.”

29

“Unspoken”

We never said goodbye—

maybe that's why it echoes still.

I spoke in stares,

you answered in smiles.

And somewhere between them,

we built a world that words could never hold.

Now silence wears your voice,

and I—

I live inside all the things

we left unsaid.

30

Chapter 9

The Day Love Stopped

Looking Like You

“Healing begins the moment you realize that love can exist beyond the person who broke you.”

It didn’t happen suddenly.

There was no dramatic moment, no final goodbye echoing in my head.

It was quiet — like the way seasons change when you’re too tired to notice.

One morning, I woke up

and didn’t search for your name in my notifications.

One evening, I walked past our café

and didn’t stop to stare at the corner seat where you once smiled at me.

That’s when I knew —

love was learning to breathe without your face attached to it.

31

You used to define everything I knew about love.

The warmth, the ache, the chaos.

But slowly, love began to mean other things —

the sound of rain on an empty road,

a song I hum to myself,

a sunset I don't rush to photograph.

It took me months to understand

that moving on isn't forgetting.

It's remembering without pain.

You taught me love, yes —

but you also taught me how fragile it can be.

And maybe that's okay.

Maybe every heartbreak is just a gentle reminder that love isn't about who stays —

it's about what remains when they don't.

That day, love stopped looking like you.

And for the first time,

it looked like me — standing alone,

still broken, but finally breathing.

32

“Love Without a Face”

Love used to wear your smile,

walk in your footsteps,

breathe through your name.

But now—

it lives in mornings I wake unafraid, in nights I sleep without your ghost beside me.

You were a chapter.

Love was the book.

And I—

I finally turned the page.

33

Chapter 10

The Art Of Letting Go

“Letting go isn’t about forgetting them. It’s about remembering yourself.”

For the longest time, I thought letting go meant erasing you—

your photos, your texts, your voice that still echoed in my head.

But love doesn’t work that way.

It doesn’t leave just because you tell it to.

Letting go felt like teaching my heart a new language—

one without your name in every sentence.

At first, it hurt to even try.

Every corner of my room had your memory folded into it.

Every song I played became a confession I never made.

But slowly, I started reclaiming those spaces.

I began sleeping on your side of the bed, drinking coffee from your favorite cup, 34

writing poetry that didn't begin with "you."

I didn't realize healing had no fireworks, no applause.

It came quietly,

in small, uncelebrated victories—

like walking past the street where we said goodbye and not looking back this time.

You see, love teaches us to hold on.

But life teaches us to release.

And somewhere between the two,

we learn that strength isn't in keeping, it's in accepting what cannot stay.

Maybe you'll always be a part of my story, but not my home.

And that's okay.

Because the art of letting go

isn't about losing love—

it's about finding peace in the space it left behind.

35

"Unholding"

I let you go—
not like a storm,
but like dusk fading into night.
No anger,
no farewell.
Just quiet acceptance
and a soft whisper—
“thank you for being my almost.”
Some loves aren’t meant to stay,
they’re meant to teach.
And you—
you taught me how to let go
without hating what I had to lose.



Chapter 11

Where Pain Learnt To Sleep

“Healing doesn’t mean the pain disappears. It just learns where to rest.”

37

There was a time when I woke up with your name stuck to my breath.

Mornings were not mornings — they were echoes of your absence.

The world would begin,

but I wouldn’t.

I’d sit by the window with my half-burnt coffee, watching the sunlight crawl across the floor, and somehow, I’d still find a shadow shaped like you.

It’s strange how the heart remembers pain as if it were a person who still lived here.

For months, I thought time would wash you away.

But love isn’t ink — it’s carved.

You can’t scrub it off;

you learn to live around it.

I remember that one night —

the one where I promised myself I wouldn’t cry again.

But memory has its own cruelty.

You came back in dreams,

38

wearing that same smile that once made me believe in forever.

And when I woke up,

the room felt like a graveyard of unsaid words.

But slowly...

something inside me began to change.

It didn't happen like healing stories in movies —

no sunrise, no miracle, no new love waiting to fix me.

It was quieter.

It began the day I stopped trying to forget.

The day I allowed myself to remember — without breaking.

That's when pain started learning how to sleep.

I started walking more.

Not to escape, but to breathe again.

The streets we once wandered became my therapy —

each step, a soft goodbye I never said.

Sometimes I'd catch the scent of jasmine, the one you used to wear.

For a second, it hurt —

but then it didn't.

It became just a fragrance again.

That's how I knew I was healing —

when ordinary things stopped feeling like you.

There's something poetic about recovery.

It doesn't ask for applause.

It doesn't arrive with clarity.

It just happens —

in moments so small,

you almost miss them.

Like the first time I slept through the night without thinking of your last message.

Like the first time I smiled at an old memory instead of drowning in it.

Like the first time I realized

I didn't need closure —

I just needed peace.

The truth is, pain doesn't vanish.

It lingers, quietly —

in songs, in scents, in half-written thoughts.

But it changes shape.

It becomes softer, slower, less like fire, more like wind.

And one day, you wake up,
and your chest doesn't ache anymore.

You still remember everything —
but it no longer hurts to do so.

That's when you know:
pain has finally found its place.

It doesn't scream anymore.

It just rests —
peacefully, in the corners of your heart that once burned.

Maybe that's what healing truly means —
not becoming who you were before, but becoming someone who can carry
the pain without collapsing.

I still miss you sometimes.

Not the way I used to —
not with desperation or longing,
but with gratitude.

Because even the ache has become a story worth keeping.

And when I lie down at night now,

41

I don't fight my memories anymore.

I let them visit,
sit beside me for a while,
and then watch them drift away quietly —
like tired ghosts finally finding rest.
Because the heart,
when it learns peace,
doesn't forget.
It forgives.
And that's where pain learns to sleep.

42

“Lullaby of Scars”

Once, pain screamed—
it tore through my nights,
echoed in every heartbeat.
Now, it whispers.
Now, it hums.
Once, love burned.
Now, it glows—
a faint light I follow home.
I don't hide my scars anymore.

I name them.

I sing them to sleep.

Because healing isn't silence,
it's the soft music that plays
after the storm has gone.

43

Chapter 12

The First Morning Without You

“Some mornings don't need sunlight to feel new — they just need a heart that finally stops reaching for what's gone.”

That morning was different.

Not louder. Not brighter. Just... quieter.

I woke up before the alarm.

No dreams, no flashbacks — only the soft hum of the ceiling fan, and a strange stillness I hadn't felt in months.

It was the first morning I didn't reach for my phone to check if you'd texted.

The first morning I didn't replay your voice in my mind.

The first morning I realized — I was breathing, and it didn't hurt to do so.

I walked to the window.

The sky was pale, still stretching its colors awake.

44

The world felt new, as if someone had gently pressed reset on everything
I'd once broken.

You weren't there,

and yet, it didn't feel empty anymore.

For the first time,

I made coffee without feeling like I was making it for two.

I sat by the same chair you once called our spot, and it didn't ache.

It just existed — like it always had, long before we turned it into something
sacred.

I noticed how sunlight touched the table, how the air carried the faint scent
of monsoon.

There was a softness in the silence —

as if the universe whispered,

“See? You can still find peace without them.”

And in that moment,

I realized healing wasn't something that happens to you —

it happens within you,

45

quietly, when you stop searching for the person who left and start searching
for the person you lost in their love —

yourself.

I spent that morning doing nothing grand.

No new beginnings.

No declarations.

Just small things — washing the mug, watering the plant, listening to songs
I once avoided.

Each little act felt like reclaiming a piece of myself I'd given away too
easily.

For so long, I thought love was about holding on.

Now I was learning that sometimes,

love is about letting go with gentleness —

about allowing life to move forward, even when your heart still looks back.

I stepped outside, barefoot.

The earth was cold, still wet from last night's rain.

The air smelled like new beginnings —

not dramatic, not loud — just soft.

46

Like forgiveness.

I closed my eyes,

and for the first time,

I didn't wish for your return.

I didn't imagine your hand in mine.

I just stood there,
feeling the calm that comes after every storm.
Maybe that's what healing truly is —
not the absence of pain,
but the presence of peace.
You see, love doesn't always end in hate.
Sometimes, it ends in acceptance.
You stop blaming, stop questioning, stop rewriting endings that never
belonged to you.
And when you finally do,
the heart finds a new rhythm — one that beats for itself.
That morning, I looked at the mirror —
and I saw someone I hadn't seen in a long time: me.
47
Not the version that waited, or begged, or broke —
but the one who survived.
The one who learned that closure isn't something you get from others —
it's something you give to yourself, in the quiet forgiveness of a new day.
That morning didn't need you to exist.
It was mine —
entirely, beautifully, and finally mine.

“Morning After You”

I woke without your name today—

and the sky didn’t collapse.

The world moved,

the birds sang,

and I —

I finally listened.

The bed still had your ghost,

but it felt softer now,

like memory,

not ache.

Love left,

but life stayed.

And maybe that’s all healing is —

learning to live

where love once lived too.

*Chapter 13**I’m Learning To Love The*

Quiet

“Silence used to scare me. Now, it feels like home.”

There was a time when silence was unbearable.

When every quiet room felt like a reminder that you weren’t coming back.

When the stillness after midnight sounded louder than heartbreak itself.

But lately, the quiet has changed.

It no longer feels empty —

it feels alive, patient, almost gentle.

Maybe that’s what healing really does —

it doesn’t erase the noise of the past; it teaches you how to sit beside it,
without shaking.

50

Now, I find myself seeking silence.

Not to hide,

but to listen.

To hear my own thoughts again —

the ones that had been drowned out by the echo of your voice.

There was a time when every song was about you.

Now I can play them again

and not bleed through the lyrics.

They sound different —

not because the music changed,

but because I did.

I still remember the way you filled every space with your laughter.

It used to spill through the walls,

turning even the smallest moments into something luminous.

And when you left,

the house felt haunted by your echo.

For months, I kept the TV on,

51

the lights bright,

the curtains open —

as if distraction could replace presence.

But it never did.

Then one evening,

I turned everything off.

No sound.

No movement.

Just me,

and the quiet I had been running from.

And something beautiful happened —

I didn't feel lonely.

I felt free.

There's a different kind of strength in solitude —

the kind that doesn't shout or prove, but simply is.

It's not about closing your heart to the world; it's about opening it to yourself again.

52

I started doing small things —

reading without checking my phone,

sitting on the terrace during sunsets, listening to my own breathing as if it were a poem.

And slowly,

I realized that quiet isn't emptiness —

it's presence.

I talk to myself more now.

Not the broken kind of talking,

but the healing kind —

where you learn to answer your own questions, to be the comfort you once begged for.

The quiet became a mirror,

reflecting parts of me I'd forgotten.

The curious dreamer.

The soft thinker.

The one who used to write not for love, but for life.

53

Maybe heartbreak isn't about losing someone.

Maybe it's about returning to who you were before love taught you how to forget yourself.

Now, when the night grows still,

I don't crave noise.

I sit beside the silence,

and it feels like sitting beside an old friend.

Sometimes,

I think of you too —

not with tears,

but with a smile that says,

you were a beautiful noise in my story, but peace is my new music now.

54

“The Sound of Silence”

There was a time

when silence broke me.

Now—

it rebuilds me.

Each pause,

each breath,

each moment without your echo

teaches me how to listen again.

To myself.

To life.

To peace.

The world no longer needs to be loud for me to feel alive.

Sometimes,

the quiet sings louder than love ever did.

55

Chapter 14

When I Started Smiling Again

“Sometimes joy doesn’t arrive like fireworks — it returns quietly, in the shape of a breath you didn’t know you’d been holding.”

It didn’t happen suddenly.

No grand revelation, no cinematic morning.

Just a small laugh that escaped without my permission.

It was afternoon, the kind that dripped with lazy sunlight.

I was at a roadside tea stall,

watching a child chase a balloon that kept slipping from his fingers.

He kept running, falling, getting up again —

and when he finally caught it,

his grin lit up the street.

Something inside me softened.

For months, I had forgotten that kind of joy —

the effortless, ordinary kind.

56

And before I could stop myself, I smiled.

Not because I wanted to —

but because my heart finally remembered how.

I didn't realize how long it had been since I'd done that.

Smiling had become a foreign language, one I once spoke fluently but lost somewhere in your absence.

But that day,

it returned.

The world hadn't changed —

I had.

The same roads,

the same faces,

the same endless sky.

But everything looked a little softer, a little more forgiving.

Healing, I've learned, doesn't come all at once.

It comes in fragments —

57

in small joys, in unexpected laughter, in mornings where you forget to ache.

I started noticing beauty again.

In the smell of fresh rain.

In the sound of someone humming nearby.

In the way sunlight fell through the window and warmed the dust that danced in the air.

Love once taught me how to feel deeply.

Pain taught me how to survive.

But healing... healing taught me how to see again.

It's strange —

how one day you stop waiting for texts that never come, stop rereading old chats,

stop searching for your reflection in someone else's eyes.

That's when peace enters —

quietly, humbly,

like an old friend you didn't realize you'd missed.

Sometimes I still think of you —

58

not with longing,

but with kindness.

You were a chapter.

And chapters end.

But I've learned to be grateful for the book itself —

for everything it taught me,

for every scar that now blooms like a lesson.

Smiling again didn't mean I stopped missing you.

It meant I stopped punishing myself for it.

Now, when I laugh,

it isn't forced.

It isn't stolen from sorrow.

It belongs to me.

And maybe that's what moving on truly is —

not forgetting who hurt you,

but remembering who you were before you were hurt.

That evening,

59

I walked home humming an old song — the one we once played on repeat.

But it didn't break me this time.

It just felt like music again.

And somewhere between the chorus and the last line, I caught myself smiling —

genuinely, freely, softly —

as if joy had never left,

only waited for me to return.

60

“The Return of Light”

I smiled again today—

not because the pain is gone,

but because I've learned to carry it gently.

The sun fell on my face,

the breeze whispered your name,

and neither hurt.

I smiled again—

for the first time,

for myself.

Because healing isn't forgetting the dark, it's remembering

how to stand in the light

without fear.

*Chapter 15**When I Met Myself Again*

“The most beautiful reunion in life isn’t with a lover — it’s with the version of yourself you thought was gone forever.”

For a long time, I thought losing you meant losing myself.

You had become the mirror I used to recognize who I was.

When you left, I couldn’t find my reflection anymore.

Every habit had your shadow in it.

Every dream had your shape stitched somewhere inside.

I was alive, but not living —

moving, but not moving on.

Days blurred into nights,

and nights into more silence.

I kept hoping time would bring me back to me, but time doesn’t heal —

it just gives you enough space to hear your own heart again.

And then one morning, it happened —

not dramatically, not suddenly —

but gently, like dawn returning after a long, sleepless winter.

I caught myself in the mirror —

unplanned, unexpected —
and for the first time in months,
I didn't see a broken person staring back.
I saw someone softer, wiser,
someone who had walked through fire and still managed to bloom.
It hit me then —
healing isn't about becoming who you were before the heartbreak.
It's about becoming someone stronger because of it.
I remembered how I used to write —
before love turned my words into prayers.
I remembered how I used to laugh —
before laughter became proof of survival.
And I remembered how I used to dream —
63
before dreams carried your name.
I started doing small things that made me feel alive again.
Writing poetry that wasn't about you.
Sitting in cafés alone and enjoying it.
Dancing to music without needing a reason.
It felt strange at first —

loving my own company after being haunted by yours.

But slowly, the strangeness turned into comfort.

And comfort turned into peace.

One evening, I sat by the lake —

the same one where we once made promises that never survived the rain.

The sky was painted in orange and forgiveness.

I looked at the reflection of the water, and this time, I didn't search for you in it.

I saw me —

the me who could still love, still hope, still write.

I realized that meeting myself again didn't mean erasing you.

64

It meant thanking you —

for teaching me that I can lose everything and still not lose the capacity to feel.

You taught me pain.

But pain taught me strength.

And strength —

taught me me.

Now, when I think of love,

I don't think of someone's face.

I think of peace.

Of calm mornings.

Of slow days and soft smiles.

Of being whole — even alone.

Maybe this is what healing looks like —

not moving on to someone else,

but moving closer to yourself.

For the longest time,

I thought love was about finding a home in another person.

65

Now I know —

sometimes, love is about returning home to your own soul.

And when I met myself again,

I didn't apologize for all the ways I had changed.

I embraced it.

Because heartbreak didn't destroy me —

it introduced me to the version of myself that could finally stand in the light without trembling.

66

“The Mirror Spoke”

I met myself again—

not the one who begged,
but the one who breathed.

I touched my scars
and they didn't ache —
they shimmered.

I smiled at the reflection
that once looked for you,
and whispered,
“You're enough now.”

Love left,
but I remained —
and in staying,

I found everything
I was ever searching for.



Chapter 16

Love Started Feeling Like Peace

“Maybe love was never meant to be loud.

Maybe it was always meant to feel like coming home.”

68

There was a time when I thought love had to hurt to be real.

That the more it broke you, the deeper it must be.

I mistook chaos for connection,

and noise for affection.

But healing has a way of teaching you what love truly is —

not the kind that shouts and storms, but the kind that whispers,

stays,

and makes you breathe easier.

It started slowly —

the way sunrise begins, shy but certain.

The ache in my chest softened,

and the space you once filled stopped feeling empty.

It began to feel peaceful.

I used to think love was fire.

But now, it feels like the ocean —

vast, calm, endlessly forgiving.

Maybe that's what growing through pain does to you.

69

It makes you crave softness, not drama.

It makes you appreciate the quiet kind of love —

the one that doesn't demand to be seen, just felt.

I started to fall in love again —

not with a person,

but with life.

With the way mornings look when sunlight seeps through curtains.

With the taste of coffee after a long silence.

With the sound of rain on the roof when I have no one to message.

Love started to feel like calm again —

not butterflies,

not racing heartbeats,

but steady breaths.

And maybe that's what real love is —

not losing yourself in someone,

but finding yourself beside them.

70

I began to unlearn everything I knew about love.

That it must be grand,

or loud,

or perfect.

Now I know —

love is quiet consistency.

It's holding space for someone's silence.

It's understanding without needing to explain.

Sometimes, I still remember you —

but it doesn't hurt anymore.

It just reminds me of how far I've come.

How I once mistook pain for passion, and how now, I can tell the difference.

Maybe that's what growth is —

not building walls,

but planting gardens inside them.

These days, I don't chase love.

I attract peace.

Because when you learn to be calm within yourself, 71

you stop craving storms around you.

If someone comes now,
they'll meet a heart that's no longer desperate to be understood

—

but ready to be respected.

I no longer want the kind of love that burns bright and ends fast.

I want the kind that glows quietly —

steady, patient, true.

And when I say “love” now,

it doesn't mean you anymore.

It means mornings without tears.

It means being gentle with myself.

It means forgiving what I can't forget.

I think love has finally changed its shape for me.

It's no longer a wound.

It's a resting place.

Love, now —

feels like peace.

72

“The Shape of Love”

Love used to roar,

now it hums.

It used to burn,

now it warms.

It used to hurt,

now it heals.

It used to be someone else,

now—

it's me.

73

Chapter 17

I Stopped Writing About You

“You’ll know you’ve healed when your pain stops asking to be turned into poetry.”

There was a time when every line I wrote bled your name.

Every metaphor hid your memory.

Every poem was a letter I never sent.

You were everywhere —

in my words,

in my pauses,

in the ink that refused to run dry.

I used to think writing about you was my way of keeping you alive —

that as long as I wrote,
some part of us still existed between the lines.

But the truth is,

I was just keeping my wounds open

74

and calling it art.

It's strange how heartbreak turns you into a poet, how pain teaches you to
find rhythm in ache, beauty in loss.

But there comes a time

when even pain grows tired of being rewritten.

And one day,

I sat with my pen,

opened my journal —

and nothing came.

No sadness.

No longing.

No you.

Just blank pages,

and peace.

For a moment, it scared me —

the silence.

The emptiness where once your chaos lived.

75

I thought maybe I'd lost my muse.

But then I realized —

I hadn't lost inspiration.

I had outgrown obsession.

I didn't need to turn my feelings into poetry anymore.

Because I had finally started living them instead.

I used to write to escape my memories.

Now, I write to celebrate my healing.

I write about rain without remembering your umbrella.

About sunsets without recalling your hand in mine.

About love —

without meaning you.

And that's when I knew —

I had let go.

Not the loud kind of letting go,

where you delete, block, erase —

but the quiet kind,

where you simply stop remembering.

It's not that you vanished from my story.

You just stopped being the whole book.

Now, you're a paragraph in a chapter I've already finished reading.

Sometimes, I still go through my old poems.

The ones soaked in grief.

And I don't cry anymore.

I just smile — softly —

for the person who once wrote them,

for the heart that once hurt so deeply and still chose to heal.

I stopped writing about you,

and in that pause,

I started writing about me.

The version of me that survived.

That learned.

That finally understood —

some love stories aren't meant to be eternal; they're meant to teach you
how to love yourself again.

And maybe that's the most beautiful ending of all —

when your words no longer belong to your wounds, but to your wisdom.

78

“Blank Pages”

I stopped writing about you,
and the silence didn't hurt —
it healed.

My poems no longer ache,
they breathe.

The ink that once carried your name
now carries mine.

Because sometimes,
the most poetic thing you can do
is stop turning pain into art
and start turning peace
into life.

79

Chapter 18

The Day I Forgave You

“Forgiveness isn't saying you were right.

It's saying I deserve peace more than I deserve answers.”

For months, I carried the bitterness like a second heartbeat.

Every thought of you tasted like rust —

metallic, heavy, and cold.

I told myself I was healing,

but deep down, I was still holding you hostage inside my mind.

I wanted to be over you,

but I also wanted you to understand —

to see the damage you left behind,

to regret the way you let me drown quietly in the love we built together.

But one morning, I woke up tired.

Not sad, not angry —

80

just exhausted from carrying the weight of something I could never rewrite.

And that's when it hit me —

forgiveness isn't about them.

It's about releasing yourself

from the need to make them see your pain.

So I sat by the window,

the light barely spilling in,

and whispered to the silence,

“I forgive you.”

It wasn't dramatic.

It wasn't even emotional.

It was soft, quiet, real.

A whisper that felt like an exhale after years of holding my breath.

I forgave you —

not because you deserved it,

but because I deserved to stop remembering you through anger.

I forgave you for the words you never said.

For the promises that wilted before they bloomed.

81

For making me believe forever was a thing that existed between fragile hearts.

But mostly,

I forgave you for not knowing how to love me the way I loved you.

It's strange —

how forgiveness feels lighter than revenge, how peace feels louder than closure.

After that day,

your name stopped burning in my chest.

It simply became a sound —

familiar, but harmless.

I started seeing you differently —

not as the person who broke me,

but as the person who unknowingly taught me how strong I could be when everything fell apart.

I stopped waiting for apologies.

Because sometimes, people can't say sorry for what they never understood.

And sometimes, life gives you the lesson without the explanation.

82

Forgiveness isn't about forgetting.

It's about remembering without pain.

It's the art of looking back

without needing to rewrite the ending.

You were a chapter —

beautiful, raw, unforgettable —

but not the book.

And I think I'm finally okay with that.

So I let go.

Not with hatred,

but with peace.

Because healing doesn't always mean moving on from love —

sometimes it means carrying it gently, without letting it weigh you down anymore.

And that's the day I truly forgave you —

when I realized your leaving wasn't my ending, it was my beginning.

83

“I Forgive You”

I forgive you —

not because the hurt is gone,

but because it no longer controls me.

I forgive you —

for all the things you never became, and for all the love I thought you were.

I forgive you —

because hate was heavy,

and peace felt lighter.

And maybe someday,

you'll think of me too —

and smile,

the way I do now

when I think of you.

84

Chapter 19

I Started Sleeping

Peacefully Again

“It took me months to realize that peace doesn’t come when memories stop — it comes when they no longer hurt.”

For a long time, the nights were cruel.

Sleep was a stranger I kept chasing, and every time I closed my eyes,

I saw you —

your laughter, your last goodbye, your silence that said too much.

I’d lie awake for hours,

talking to ghosts that didn’t answer anymore.

Even the moon became a witness —

it saw me cry on nights when I promised myself I wouldn’t.

Every inch of my bed remembered you.

Every pillow carried a memory.

85

Even my dreams weren’t mine anymore —

they were just reruns of the moments I couldn’t forget.

I thought healing meant forgetting you.

But it didn’t.

Healing meant being able to remember you, and still fall asleep without breaking.

And one night, it happened —
quietly, softly, without warning.
I laid down,
the same way I always did —
but this time,
my mind didn't wander to the past.
It stayed here,
in this moment,
in this peace.

I didn't count the messages that never came.
I didn't scroll through old pictures.
I didn't talk to your absence like I used to.

86

I just... closed my eyes.
And it didn't hurt.
For the first time in forever,
sleep came gently —
like forgiveness wrapped in warmth.
I woke up with sunlight kissing my face, and no heaviness in my chest.
No dreams about what was,

no aching for what could've been.

That's when I realized —

peace doesn't arrive with noise.

It comes quietly,

when you stop asking why

and start accepting what is.

It's not that I stopped missing you.

It's just that I stopped needing to.

You became a memory,

not a wound.

87

And memories —

don't keep you awake forever.

The world looked softer that morning.

Even the sky seemed lighter,

as if it knew I'd finally slept without ghosts beside me.

Healing, I learned,

doesn't always announce itself.

Sometimes, it's as simple as closing your eyes and realizing the ache didn't follow you this time.

And that's what freedom felt like —

not fireworks,
not celebration,
just the simple joy
of resting in peace
with your own heart.

88

“The First Peaceful Night”

I slept last night —
really slept.
No dreams,
no tears,
no name on my lips.
Just the sound of my breath
and the softness of peace
curling around my chest.
The stars didn’t hurt to look at.
The silence didn’t sting.
I slept last night —
and for the first time,
I didn’t miss you in my dreams.

*Chapter 20**The Day I Realized I Was**Happy Again*

“Happiness doesn’t always arrive with laughter — sometimes, it returns quietly, like sunlight finding its way through closed curtains.”

I didn’t plan it.

I didn’t even notice it at first.

It wasn’t a big moment —

no celebration, no revelation.

It was just a morning like any other.

The sky was soft,

the tea was warm,

and for the first time in months,

the silence didn’t feel empty.

I was brushing my hair in front of the mirror, half lost in thought,

90

when I caught my reflection smiling —

not the kind of smile you wear for others, but the kind that happens when you’ve made peace with yourself.

And that’s when it hit me —

I was happy.

Not because something new had arrived, but because the old pain had quietly left.

It's strange, isn't it?

How happiness doesn't always return with noise —

sometimes it tiptoes back into your life, and you only notice it when you stop expecting it.

There was a time when I measured happiness by presence —

by who texted first,

by who stayed,

by who remembered.

Now, I measure it by peace —

by how deeply I can breathe,

by how softly my heart rests at night.

91

I started noticing small joys again —

the sound of a friend's laugh,

the comfort of rain tapping on my window, the way my favorite song feels lighter now.

I no longer need constant reminders that life is good.

I can feel it —

in the quiet moments,

in the way my chest doesn't ache when I think of you, in the way my hands
have stopped reaching for ghosts.

Happiness used to feel impossible —

something that belonged to the version of me before you.

But it turns out,

happiness isn't something we find.

It's something that returns

when we stop chasing what hurt us.

You once made my world bright.

And when you left,

I thought the light went with you.

But light was never yours —

92

it was always mine.

And today, I see it again —

in the calmness of my mornings,

in the warmth of my own laughter,

in the quiet realization that I made it through.

I'm not waiting for someone anymore.

Not for closure.

Not for a comeback.

Not for love.

Because life feels full again —

even with the empty spaces.

And maybe that's what healing truly means —

not fixing what broke,

but building something beautiful with what's left.

I am not the person I was when you left.

And thank God for that.

Because the person standing here today —

smiling softly at her own reflection —

isn't waiting for love anymore.

She is love.

93

“The Return of Joy”

It didn't come as laughter —

it came as calm.

It didn't dance in storms —

it sat beside my silence.

Happiness —

didn't knock on my door.

It bloomed quietly

in the corners of my heart

I thought would never feel again.

And when I saw myself smiling,

I realized —

I had finally come home.

94

Chapter 21

The Day I No Longer

Missed You

“One day, you'll think of them and realize — your heart didn't skip, it just stayed still. That's when you'll know you're free.”

It didn't happen overnight.

Healing never does.

It came slowly, like dawn—

soft, hesitant, but certain.

There was a time when I used to miss you without warning —

in songs, in smells, in passing faces.

You lived in the smallest corners of my world.

Even silence used to sound like you.

Every time I heard your name, my chest would tighten.

Every time someone mentioned your city, my heart would wander back.

Missing you had become muscle memory —

95

something I did without thinking, without permission.

But time has a way of untangling the things we once swore were permanent.

Little by little,

the ache became less sharp.

Your absence became less loud.

And the spaces you once filled

began to feel like mine again.

Then one afternoon, it happened —

quietly, almost carelessly.

Someone mentioned your name in a conversation, and I didn't flinch.

No rush of memories.

No sinking in my chest.

Just... nothing.

It wasn't numbness —

it was peace.

The kind of peace that feels earned.

96

I realized then —

I didn't miss you anymore.

Not because I forgot you,

but because I finally accepted what we were —

and what we weren't.

You were a chapter.

A beautiful one.

But every story moves forward,

and mine has.

For so long, I thought missing you was proof of love.

But now I know —

sometimes the greatest form of love

is letting the past rest where it belongs.

I still remember you,

but it's softer now.

Like a song from a time I loved deeply but no longer need to replay.

There's no ache in the melody anymore — just gratitude.

97

Because even though you left, you taught me things only heartbreak could

—

how to value peace,

how to love myself enough to walk away, how to stand in my own silence
and still feel whole.

Now when I think of you,

I don't ask why.

I don't wish if only.

I just smile,

quietly,

for the memory that once made me feel so alive.

And that's what freedom really is —

not forgetting,

but remembering

without bleeding.

I don't miss you anymore.

And somehow,

that feels like the gentlest victory of all.

98

“When Missing Turned Into Peace”

I used to miss you

like lungs miss air.

Now,

I breathe just fine.

Your name no longer trembles on my tongue.

Your memory no longer weighs on my chest.

I still remember,

but it doesn't hurt.

I still care,

but it doesn't cling.

Because love didn't end —

it just changed shape,

and finally

set me free.

99

Chapter 22

The Day I Thanked The Pain

“Sometimes, what breaks you isn't meant to destroy you — it's meant to rebuild you into the person you were always meant to be.”

For the longest time,

I cursed the pain.

I hated it for stealing my peace,

for hollowing out the parts of me that once felt full.

Every tear felt like punishment.

Every sleepless night, a sentence I didn't deserve.

I used to think pain was the villain in my story.

That if I could somehow erase it,

I'd get my old self back —

the one who believed in forever,

who loved without fear.

But life had other plans.

100

It didn't give me back who I was —

it introduced me to who I could be.

And one evening,

as I sat alone watching the sky bleed into shades of orange and forgiveness,

I realized something —

I wasn't angry anymore.

Not at you.

Not at love.

Not at life.

Because without the pain,

I would've never met this version of myself —

the one who can stand in silence and not tremble, who can love deeply
without losing herself, who can look at endings and still find beginnings

hiding underneath.

Pain became my teacher.

It stripped away my illusions.

It tore down everything false and fragile.

And in that emptiness,

101

I found truth.

It taught me that healing isn't a return —

it's a rebirth.

That sometimes the heart has to break so it can open wider.

And for that,

I found myself whispering —

“Thank you.”

Thank you to the nights that hurt.

Thank you to the tears that burned.

Thank you to the goodbye that forced me to grow.

Because without them,

I would've never learned that peace was something I could build on my own.

Pain taught me strength —

the kind that doesn't shout,

but endures quietly.

It taught me that love isn't about possession, it's about presence —
and sometimes, the most loving thing you can do is let go.

102

Now when I look back, I don't see tragedy.

I see transformation.

I see a girl who once thought she'd never smile again now laughing softly
at the sky.

I see someone who thought she'd never heal now holding peace in her
hands like a prayer answered.

And that's the beauty of pain —

it doesn't ask permission to enter your life, but it always leaves you wiser
than before.

So yes,

I thanked the pain.

For breaking me just enough
to show me what I was made of.

Because sometimes,

you need to lose everything
to learn that you were always enough.

103

“Thank You, Pain”

Thank you, pain —
for teaching me how to breathe through storms.
For reminding me
that softness is not weakness,
and endings are not failures.
You burned me,
but you also lit the way.
I no longer fear you —
I bow to you.
Because you didn’t come to stay,
you came to shape.
And what I’ve become —
is your most beautiful aftermath.

104

Chapter 23

When I Started Believing In

Love Again

“You don’t fall in love again to replace someone — you do it to remind your heart that it still knows how to bloom.”

For a long time, I thought love was something I had to avoid —

like fire that had burned me once and could do it again.

I built walls around my heart,

quiet, invisible walls made of fear and memory.

I told myself I was safer alone.

That I didn't need anyone to make me feel complete.

And maybe, for a while, that was true.

But healing has a strange way of softening even the hardest edges.

One day, you wake up,

and the silence that used to comfort you starts feeling a little too quiet.

You see couples laughing on the street, 105

and instead of pain, you feel a tiny flicker of warmth —

the kind that whispers, maybe again.

It didn't happen with fireworks.

It began with small moments.

A kind smile from a stranger.

A conversation that felt effortless.

A look that didn't remind me of you —

but of something gentle, something real.

And for the first time in years,

my heart didn't panic.

It didn't compare.

It didn't ache.

It just listened.

That's when I realized —

I wasn't scared anymore.

Because love doesn't always arrive in grand gestures.

Sometimes, it returns quietly,

106

like light slipping through curtains after a long night.

It doesn't demand,

it doesn't rush —

it just stays.

I learned that love isn't about losing yourself to someone, it's about finding someone who reminds you of who you are.

It's not about promises,

it's about presence.

And maybe, love was never gone —

it was just waiting for me to stop fighting it.

When I met them,

it wasn't like falling again —

it was like remembering how to breathe.

Their laughter didn't heal me —
it reminded me that I had already healed.

Their touch didn't complete me —
it simply met me where I was whole.

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And that's when I truly believed —
love isn't something that happens to you.

It's something you allow,
once you've forgiven the past
and trusted your heart again.

So here I am,
standing at the edge of something new, with no expectations,
no fear —
just a quiet readiness.

Because I finally understand —
to love again isn't to forget what broke you.

It's to know it broke you,
and still choose to open your arms.

And that,
is the bravest thing I've ever done.

“Love Found Me Again”

Love didn't come knocking this time —
it just sat beside me,
in silence.

No promises,
no forever —
just peace.

It didn't ask me to forget you,
it helped me remember myself.

Love found me again,
not because I searched,
but because I stopped hiding.

And maybe that's what love really is —
not losing yourself in someone,
but finding someone
who lets you stay you.

Peaceful

“Some goodbyes don’t come with tears. They come with understanding — that love was never lost, it simply changed its place.”

It was strange how normal that day felt.

The world looked ordinary — the same streets, the same sky —

but my heart knew something was different.

I was about to see you again.

Not the you from my memories —

not the one who loved me wildly and then left quietly —

but the you who had become a distant name whispered by time.

For days, I wondered what I would say if I saw you again.

Would the ache return?

Would my hands tremble like they once did when they held everything they couldn’t keep?

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But when it finally happened, when your eyes met mine across that café after all those years, I didn’t feel the rush of pain I used to.

I didn’t feel the air escape my lungs.

I just smiled.

You looked older, calmer —

the kind of calm that comes when life teaches you enough to stop running.

And for the first time,

I didn't see you as the person who left.

I saw you as a person who was meant to teach me something beautiful —
and then move on.

We talked — not like lovers, not like strangers, but like two stories that
once shared a few pages.

There was no bitterness, no blame.

Only quiet laughter, soft pauses,

and that unspoken awareness

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that we had both outgrown the version of ourselves that once belonged
together.

At one point, you looked at me —

that familiar gaze that once made my heart collapse —

and said, "You look happy."

I smiled again, genuinely this time.

Because I was.

Not the kind of happy that depends on someone else, but the kind that
grows from within —

after you've been through storms and still choose to bloom.

And when we finally stood to leave,

our goodbye wasn't dramatic.

It wasn't wrapped in pain or regret.

It was quiet, almost gentle —

like closing a book you once loved,

knowing it changed you forever,

but understanding it's time to read something new.

I didn't cry when you walked away this time.

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I just watched you fade into the crowd, and whispered silently — thank you.

Thank you for the love,

for the lessons,

for the heartbreak that built me.

That day,

I realized closure doesn't always come in the form of words —

sometimes it comes in the form of peace sitting silently inside you.

The goodbye finally felt light,

like a bird leaving a hand that no longer tries to hold it.

And I walked away too —

not broken,

not bitter,

but free.

Because loving you was a part of my story.

But letting you go...

was the beginning of my peace.

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“Peaceful Goodbye”

We met again —

not to restart,

but to release.

Your eyes no longer hurt.

Your name no longer burned.

We laughed,

we paused,

we understood.

Some love stories don't end —

they just settle

into silence.

You were never mine to keep,

but always mine to remember —

softly,

peacefully,
like a sunset that no longer hurts to watch.

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Chapter 25

I'm Done, But My Heart

Still Whispers Your Name

“You don’t stop loving someone when you move on — you just learn to love them differently... quietly, from afar, without expectation.”

I used to think being “done” meant erasing you.

Deleting the memories, burning the letters, pretending your name was just another word.

But it’s not like that.

Healing isn’t about forgetting —

it’s about remembering without falling apart.

I am done —

done with the waiting,

done with chasing ghosts,

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done with reopening wounds that have already learned to scar beautifully.

But even now,

in the quietest corners of my night, my heart still whispers your name —

not in longing,

not in pain,

but in gratitude.

Because you existed.

Because you once looked at me like I was the only sky you saw.

Because your love, even though it didn't last, taught me the depth of feeling,

the courage of vulnerability,

and the grace of letting go.

You were my chaos,

my calm,

my lesson.

And even though I walked through fire to find myself again, 116

I wouldn't change a thing.

Some part of me will always remember you —

the way your laughter sounded like home, the way your silence felt like storm, the way you made me believe that love was meant to hurt and heal at once.

But now,

I don't want you back.

I don't crave your presence.

I just... carry your memory like a soft ache that no longer needs a cure.

I've learned that moving on doesn't mean the love disappears —

it just finds a new place to rest.

Somewhere quiet.

Somewhere peaceful.

Somewhere inside me.

And maybe that's what real healing looks like —

to stand in the ruins of what once was, and still smile at the beauty that it created.

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So yes —

I'm done.

Done searching for you in everyone.

Done bleeding for something that's already written its ending.

But my heart...

my heart still whispers your name

like a poem that refuses to end —

soft, eternal,

not out of pain,

but out of peace.

Because love —

real love —

doesn't end when the people do.

It just changes shape.

And even now,

in every sunset that glows and every silence that breathes, I can still hear it
—

your name,

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carried softly through time, like the final note of a song that never really fades.

I'm done,

but my heart still whispers your name.

And this time,

it doesn't hurt —

it heals.

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“Whispers”

I'm done chasing what broke me,

but not denying what made me.

Your name still drifts

through the quiet of my chest —

not to haunt,
but to remind me
that I once loved completely.
And maybe that's all love ever was —
not forever,
not perfect,
just true.

So when the night gets quiet,
and the world feels still,
I let my heart whisper your name —
one last time,
not in sorrow,
but in peace.

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About The Author

~ Ankit Bhatt

A writer of silence, heartbreak, and rebirth.

He writes not to be understood — but to be felt.

His words are soft whispers for those who've loved deeply and lost quietly.

Inspired by emotion more than experience, his writing carries the scent of real love — raw, unfinished, human.

Through “I’m Done, But My Heart Still Whispers Your Name,”

Ankit captures the bittersweet truth of healing —

that even when love ends, it never really leaves; it lives on in the poems, in the pauses, in the person we become after the storm.

Ankit’s voice blends romance and poetry, heartbreak and healing

—

turning pain into prose and memory into melody.

For him, every goodbye is just another beginning written softly in ink.

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Acknowledgements To everyone who once loved and lost —

this book belongs to you.

To the broken hearts that learned to beat again, to the ones who stayed up writing unsent messages, to those who learned to smile with wet eyes —

you are the reason these pages breathe.

To love — for being both my muse and my undoing.

To pain — for teaching me how to write what words alone couldn’t hold.

And to time —

for proving that healing doesn’t erase, it transforms.

Lastly, to you, the reader —

thank you for walking through these chapters with open hands and open heart.

If even one line here made you feel seen, then every tear that fell while writing was worth it.

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Final Note To The Reader Maybe you're reading this with someone still living in your heart.

Maybe you're still learning to let go.

Or maybe, like me, you've learned that some love stories don't end —
they just change their language.

This book isn't about forgetting.

It's about forgiving yourself for feeling too much.

It's about the quiet kind of love —

the one you carry in your chest long after the goodbye.

And if your heart still whispers their name, don't hush it.

Let it.

Because whispers are not weakness —

they're reminders that you once lived, once loved, once felt something that was real.

You're not broken.

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You're becoming.

And somewhere in this becoming,

you'll find peace —

the kind that stays.

– With love and light,

~ Ankit Bhatt

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Dedication

For the one who taught me what love feels like —

and what losing it does to the soul.

For the nights that turned into poems, and the mornings that whispered,
“keep going.”

For every heart that still believes —

even after breaking.

This book is for you.

For the quiet lovers,

the silent healers,

the ones who still look at love

and say, “Maybe again.”

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Connect With The Author Let's stay connected -

□ Instagram: @studywithanku_

🐦 YouTube : @studywithanku_

Share your thoughts or quotes from the book —

use #ImDoneButImGrateful ☐

You can also reach me out for ordering the quantity copies or the sample copies of the book at -

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I'm Done, But My Heart Still Whispers Your Name

~ *Ankit Bhatt*

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